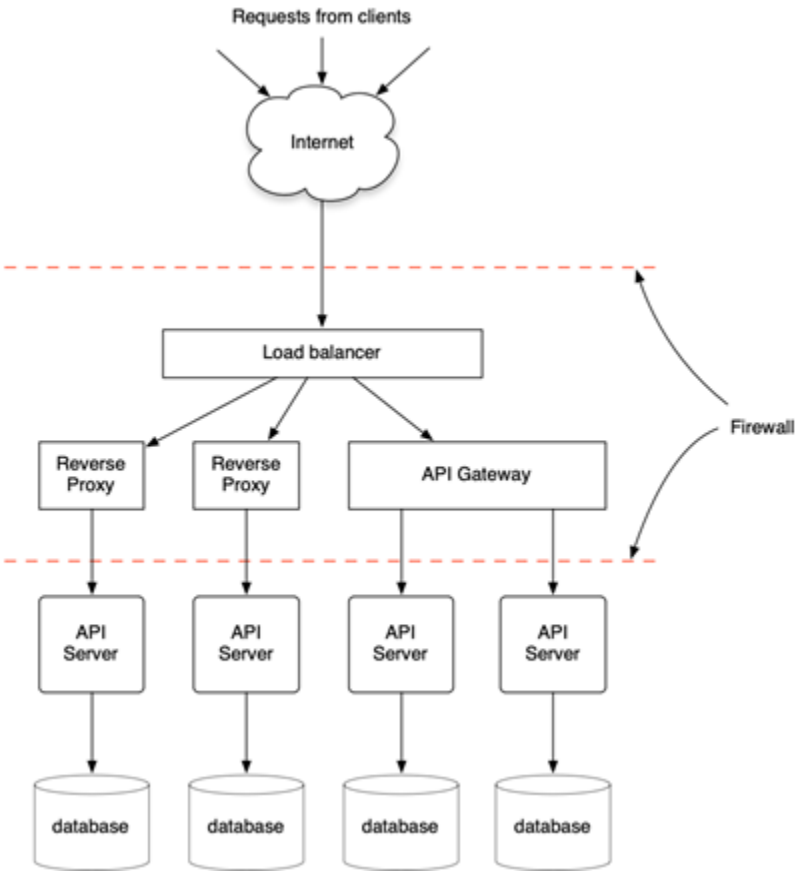


Figure 1.3 Requests to your API servers will typically pass through several other services first. A firewall works at the TCP/IP level and only allows traffic in or out of the network that matches expected flows. A load balancer routes requests to appropriate internal services based on the request and on its knowledge of how much work each server is currently doing. A reverse proxy or API gateway can take care of expensive tasks on behalf of the API server, such as terminating HTTPS connections or validating authentication credentials.

Beyond these basic elements, you may encounter a number of more specialist services: